oscillatory motion is known as damped oscillation. In other words, if an oscillator moves in a resistive medium, its amplitude goes on decreasing and the energy of the oscillator is used to do work against the resistive medium. The motion of the oscillator is said to be damped and in this case, the resistive force (or damping force) is proportional to the velocity of the oscillator.

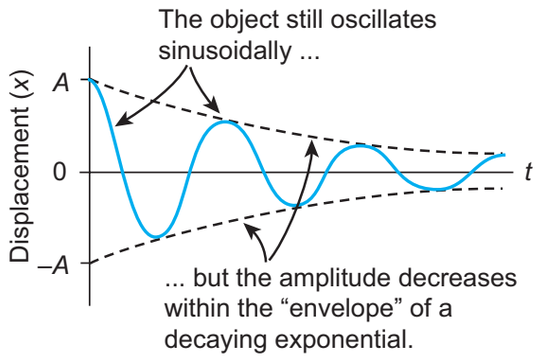


Figure 10.27 Damped harmonic oscillator – amplitude decreases as time increases.

Examples

(i) The oscillations of a pendulum (including air friction) or pendulum oscillating inside an oil filled container.

(ii) Electromagnetic oscillations in a tank circuit.

(iii) Oscillations in a dead beat and ballistic galvanometers.

10.6.3 Maintained oscillations

While playing in swing, the oscillations will stop after a few cycles, this is due to damping. To avoid damping we have to supply a push to sustain oscillations. By supplying energy from an external source, the amplitude of the oscillation can be made constant. Such vibrations are known as maintained vibrations.

Example:

The vibration of a tuning fork getting energy from a battery or from external power supply.

10.6.4 Forced oscillations

Any oscillator driven by an external periodic agency to overcome the damping is known as forced oscillator or driven oscillator.

In this type of vibration, the body executing vibration initially vibrates with its natural frequency and due to the presence of external periodic force, the body later vibrates with the frequency of the applied periodic force. Such vibrations are known as forced vibrations.

Example:

Sound boards of stringed instruments.

10.6.5 Resonance

It is a special case of forced vibrations where the frequency of external periodic force (or driving force) matches with the natural frequency of the vibrating body (driven). As a result the oscillating body begins to vibrate such that its amplitude increases at each step and ultimately it has a large amplitude. Such a phenomenon is known as resonance and the corresponding vibrations are known as resonance vibrations.

Example

The breaking of glass due to sound



The concept of resonance is used in Tuning of station (or channel) in a radio (or Television) circuits.

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